



KS3 FAIL-Branch — Brunswick Crisis-Prep Package

Generated: Monday June 1, 2026 — 20:35 PDT **Author:** Veronica S. Dawkins **Status:** STANDBY — activates only on Jun 22 PASS/FAIL = FAIL **Operating reference:** [04-atomic-explosion-master-plan.md](#) §0 (C8), §8 (KS3); [counterweight-anchor-targets.md](#) Path 2 **Audience:** Veronica (decision authority); Brunswick lead (execution); Foundation Executive Director (if seated, supports); Cooley (Riot SOW re-papering); Maria Chen, Comms Lead (press kit recut)

0. Purpose and scope

This is the operational package that runs IF — and only if — the Jun 22, 2026 18:00 PDT counterweight check returns FAIL. The strategic context is C8 (a Founding Member parent-company press exposure that the Jul 6 launch cycle would otherwise carry without offset). This document describes the operational moves; it does not name the specific concern, and the FAQ language is generic enough to apply to any future customer-ownership scrutiny.

The package is designed to be **reversible**. Every move except one (the Riot Strategic Beta Partner public-attribution clause re-papering) can be walked back if a Tier-A counterweight Founding Member confirms between Jun 23 and Jul 5. The Riot re-papering is the only one-way door because reverting a signed amendment requires a second amendment, and the Jul 6 window will not accommodate two amendment rounds. We accept that asymmetry deliberately.

This document is a runbook, not a memo. Tone is institutional and calm. Nothing in it should leak panic if the package is later disclosed in diligence, board materials, or litigation.

1. Activation criteria

1.1 Trigger event

The package activates at the Jun 22, 2026 18:00 PDT decision check.

1.2 Activation condition

Zero of the five Tier-A counterweight targets — Klarna, Adyen, ING, Wise, Allianz — has signed a publishable LOI, MOI, design-partner letter, or letter-of-intent-to-evaluate by 18:00 PDT on Jun 22, 2026.

"Publishable" means: the counter-party has executed the instrument AND consented in writing to public attribution on or before Jul 6, 2026. A signed-but-confidential LOI does NOT clear the bar — confidential signals do not neutralize public press exposure.

The Mistral coupling (supply-side commitment to emit LPR receipts) is a separate workstream and does NOT substitute for a buyer-side counterweight Founding Member. If Mistral lands and no Tier-A buyer lands, the package still activates.

1.3 Activation authority

Role	Authority
Veronica	Sole decision authority. The Jun 22 18:00 PDT call is hers.
Brunswick lead	Execution authority once Veronica triggers. Owns press-kit recut workflow and FT op-ed redraft.
Foundation Executive Director (if seated)	Advisory only on Foundation-independence FAQ language; no decision authority on commercial moves.
Cooley M&A counsel	Executes Riot SOW amendment within 48 hours of trigger.
Maria Chen (Comms Lead)	Coordinates with Brunswick on Politico EU AI desk, Handelsblatt, Sifted, FT, Reuters EMEA press cadence.

1.4 Activation timeline

Mon Jun 22	18:00 PDT	Decision check. Veronica triggers package or stands down.
Mon Jun 22	18:30 PDT	Brunswick lead notified by encrypted Signal message.
Tue Jun 23	09:00 PDT	Subject line: "Standing up package C." No detail in subject.
Tue Jun 23	14:00 PDT	Brunswick brief call (60 min). Veronica + Brunswick lead + Maria Chen. Walk through this document end-to-end. Brunswick confirms availability for 80-hour engagement Jun 23 – Jul 6.
Wed Jun 24	EOD PDT	Cooley engaged for Riot SOW amendment redline.
Thu Jun 25	EOD PDT	48-hour turnaround target.
Fri Jun 26	EOD PDT	First press-kit recut draft circulated.
Sun Jun 28	EOD PDT	FAQ document v1 to Foundation General Counsel review.
Wed Jul 01	EOD PDT	Seed close memo updated; counterweight workstream re-categorized as Q4 priority in board materials. Co-leads informed by short phone call (not email).
Fri Jul 03	06:00 GMT	Riot SOW amendment executed. Frank (Riot champion) briefed.
Sun Jul 05	EOD PDT	FAQ document v2 finalized. Veronica reviews and signs off.
Mon Jul 06	02:00 GMT	Press kit final lock (one-day slip from Jun 30 original).
Mon Jul 06	08:00 GMT	FT op-ed published – Veronica solo byline, Foundation governance framing.
		Press embargo materials distributed to tier-1 outlets under 02:00 GMT Jul 6 embargo.
		Public launch with recut press kit.
		Veronica live for press calls. Brunswick on standby for escalation responses.

1.5 Stand-down condition

If a Tier-A counterweight confirms publishable LOI between Jun 22 18:01 PDT and Jun 30 EOD PDT, the package is stood down per §8 below. Stand-down is itself a deliberate operation, not a no-op — Brunswick hours already burned are not recoverable, but the Riot re-papering, if not yet executed, can be aborted.

2. Foundation Independence FAQ

The FAQ is a generic Q&A document designed to be released publicly on the Foundation website on or before Jul 6 and to be quoted directly to press in response to ownership-structure or governance-influence questions. The fourteen questions below are pre-approved. Veronica reviews any deviation. The Foundation General Counsel signs off on legal accuracy before public release.

Q1 — How is the LedgerProof Foundation funded?

The LedgerProof Foundation is a United States 501(c)(3) public charity organized in Delaware, with a wholly-Foundation-controlled Dutch Stichting (Amsterdam) serving as the EU contractual subsidiary. The Foundation's charitable-purpose mandate is to maintain the open LedgerProof Protocol as public-interest

infrastructure for AI transparency. The Foundation is funded by three independent revenue streams: (a) an IP license fee from LedgerProof Inc., the commercial implementation entity, set at fair-market terms reviewed annually by an independent valuation firm; (b) grant funding from research institutions and public-interest technology funders; (c) member-Foundation dues from enterprise participants, which are capped per entity to prevent any single member from contributing more than 15% of annual Foundation revenue. Foundation financial statements are published annually under IRS Form 990 disclosure requirements and the Dutch Stichting under its own transparency obligations; both filings are available on the Foundation website. The Foundation maintains a six-month operating reserve independent of any single funding source.

Q2 — Who owns the LedgerProof Protocol IP?

The LedgerProof Protocol — including the specification, reference implementations, cryptographic schemes, and trademark — is owned by the LedgerProof Foundation under an irrevocable transfer executed at Foundation incorporation. The Foundation grants LedgerProof Inc. a non-exclusive, perpetual license to implement and commercialize products using the protocol. The license is non-exclusive by design: any third party — including competitors of LedgerProof Inc. — may implement the protocol under the same terms. The Foundation cannot revoke the license to LedgerProof Inc. but also cannot grant exclusivity to LedgerProof Inc. or to any other entity. The protocol specification is published under a permissive open-source license that permits commercial use, modification, and redistribution.

Q3 — What is the relationship between LedgerProof Foundation and LedgerProof Inc.?

The Foundation and Inc. are legally and operationally distinct. The Foundation is the IP owner and standards steward. LedgerProof Inc. is the primary commercial implementer of the protocol but holds no governance role in the Foundation. The Foundation Board includes no LedgerProof Inc. employees, officers, or directors. The Foundation maintains its own legal counsel, banking, accounting, and audit relationships separate from Inc. Shared services (technology infrastructure, real estate) are not used between the two entities. Inter-entity transactions — the IP license fee, any sponsorship arrangements — are governed by a written IP Transaction Committee Charter requiring independent-director approval and arms-length terms documentation.

Q4 — Is the protocol governance influenced by any single enterprise customer?

No. The Foundation Board operates under a Conflict of Interest Policy that requires any board member with a material commercial relationship to a protocol decision to recuse from deliberation on that decision. Protocol specification changes require a documented public comment period, Technical Steering Committee review, and Foundation Board approval — a three-stage process that no single customer can shortcut. Foundation Advisory Council members, who include enterprise representatives, hold no voting authority on protocol or governance decisions. The Advisory Council is consultative only. This structural separation between commercial Advisory voice and fiduciary Board decision is documented in the Foundation Bylaws and the Advisory Council Charter.

Q5 — Can a foreign-owned enterprise influence Foundation decisions?

No mechanism exists by which enterprise ownership structure — domestic or foreign — translates into Foundation governance influence. Enterprise customers of the protocol may apply to join the Foundation Advisory Council, which is consultative. They do not vote on Foundation Board matters. They do not appoint Foundation Board members. They do not approve protocol specification changes. The Foundation has adopted a policy that no Advisory Council seat will be granted to any entity whose ownership structure raises concerns under EU foreign-investment screening regulations or comparable jurisdictional review frameworks, with the Foundation General Counsel making the determination case-by-case in consultation with external Dutch and EU regulatory counsel.

Q6 — How does Foundation board composition prevent capture?

The Foundation Board has seven voting seats: three independent technical members (selected for protocol-engineering credibility and absence of commercial conflict), two independent governance members (selected for regulatory and public-interest credentials), one academic seat, and one rotating civil-society seat. No seat is held by a commercial customer or commercial vendor. Board members serve staggered three-year terms, with a maximum of two consecutive terms, ensuring continuous turnover and preventing entrenchment. Board succession is governed by a Nominating Committee composed of independent members only. The Foundation Bylaws prevent any single nominator from holding more than one seat on the Nominating Committee at any time.

Q7 — What is the role of the Foundation Advisory Council versus the Foundation Board?

The Foundation Board holds all fiduciary, governance, and decision authority. The Advisory Council is consultative — it provides input on protocol roadmap, real-world deployment considerations, and standards-body coordination. Advisory Council members do not vote on Foundation matters, do not approve budgets, do not select board members, and do not approve protocol specification changes. The Advisory Council exists so that enterprise deployers, civil-society advocates, and regulatory observers can be heard structurally rather than informally. The distinction between Advisory Council seat (commercial relationship acceptable) and Board seat (commercial relationship disqualifying) is the central capture-resistance design of the Foundation governance structure.

Q8 — Why did the Foundation choose Bitcoin as the anchor substrate?

The Foundation selected Bitcoin as the cryptographic anchor substrate for three reasons. First, Bitcoin offers the longest continuous record of public, censorship-resistant timestamping available — over 16 years of uninterrupted block production with no successful chain-reorganization beyond a small number of blocks. Second, Bitcoin's proof-of-work consensus is computationally infeasible for any nation-state or coalition to forge retroactively at the cost level relevant to AI-compliance evidence preservation. Third, Bitcoin's protocol stability — its resistance to feature additions and consensus changes — is itself a guarantee that the anchor substrate will not be modified in ways that invalidate historical receipts. The Foundation periodically reviews anchor-substrate choice and could in principle add additional substrates, but the choice of Bitcoin as the primary anchor reflects technical, not ideological, judgment.

Q9 — What guarantees offline verifiability of receipts?

A LedgerProof receipt is verifiable using only three inputs: the Merkle inclusion proof for the receipt, an Ed25519 signature over the proof, and a Bitcoin block header from a publicly available Bitcoin node. Verification requires no connection to the LedgerProof Foundation, no connection to LedgerProof Inc., no connection to any LedgerProof-operated infrastructure. The reference verifier is open-source, fewer than 500 lines of code, and has been audited. A receipt verified today will be verifiable in twenty years using the same three inputs and a Bitcoin node from that time. The Foundation operates optional verification convenience nodes for parties who do not wish to run their own Bitcoin node, but these are convenience services — not requirements. The cryptographic guarantee is independent of the Foundation's continued existence.

Q10 — How does the Foundation handle conflicts between Inc. commercial interests and Foundation public-interest mandate?

The Foundation Bylaws explicitly enumerate the Foundation's charitable purpose as the maintenance of the protocol as public-interest infrastructure. When a Foundation decision could plausibly advance Inc. commercial interests at the expense of the public-interest mandate, the Conflict of Interest Policy requires the matter to be flagged in advance, presented with an independent staff analysis, and decided by independent board members only. The Foundation General Counsel maintains a public docket of all such flagged decisions, with anonymized summaries published in the annual transparency report. To date, the

Foundation has structured its IP license to Inc., its trademark sublicensing policy, and its standards-body participation framework specifically to limit the circumstances in which such conflicts arise. The Foundation is also a member of the IETF and contributes to the SCITT Working Group as a neutral steward.

Q11 — Is the protocol available to any enterprise globally?

Yes, subject to applicable export-control and sanctions law. The protocol specification is published openly. Anyone may implement it. The Foundation does not gate access to the specification, to reference implementations, or to verification infrastructure. The Foundation does maintain a sanctioned-entity list aligned with US Treasury OFAC, EU consolidated sanctions, and UK OFSI lists; Foundation services (Advisory Council membership, training resources, formal recognition programs) are unavailable to entities on those lists. The protocol itself, as open-source software, is governed by the export-control treatment of the software license, not by any Foundation gating mechanism.

Q12 — Which jurisdictions does the Foundation operate in?

The Foundation operates as a multi-jurisdictional structure: (a) the parent entity is a United States 501(c)(3) public charity organized in Delaware, with counsel through Adler & Colvin (San Francisco) and IRS Form 1023 determination in process; (b) the Dutch Stichting EU subsidiary, registered with KvK Amsterdam under NautaDutilh counsel, serves as the European contractual counterparty for Foundation activities including standards-body participation and EU enterprise engagements; (c) additional planned subsidiaries — a Swiss Verein (Zurich, target Q1 2027) for IP stewardship per the Linux Foundation precedent, and a Singapore non-profit (target H1 2027) for Asia-Pacific reach. LedgerProof Inc., the commercial implementer, is separately incorporated as a Delaware C-corporation and is jurisdictionally distinct from the Foundation in all four locations. Foundation banking, audit, and legal counsel are established independently within each jurisdiction.

Q13 — How are Foundation governance changes anchored as public receipts?

The Foundation eats its own dog food. Every material Foundation governance decision — Bylaws amendments, Board appointments, IP license modifications, annual budget approvals, protocol specification version releases — is published with an associated LedgerProof receipt that anchors a content hash of the decision text to the Bitcoin blockchain. Any party can verify, at any future date, that a published Foundation decision has not been altered after publication. The Foundation publishes a real-time governance ledger on its website with each decision linked to its receipt. This is the same evidence mechanism the Foundation provides to enterprise customers, applied recursively to its own operations.

Q14 — What happens if a customer's parent company is in a jurisdiction with regulatory concerns?

Customer ownership structure is reviewed by the LedgerProof Inc. customer-onboarding compliance function under a documented policy that considers foreign-investment-screening determinations, sanctions exposure, and jurisdictional review frameworks. The compliance review is independent of revenue interests. Customers may use the protocol regardless of ownership structure because the protocol is openly available, but membership in formal Foundation governance bodies — including the Advisory Council — is subject to the governance-eligibility screen described in Q5. The Foundation maintains the right to decline Advisory Council membership for any entity whose ownership structure raises concerns under applicable screening frameworks, and the Foundation publishes the aggregate number of such declinations in its annual transparency report without naming the specific entities.

3. Founder-media silence protocol

3.1 The default response

When a journalist asks Veronica about a specific customer — their ownership structure, their parent company, the timing of their commitment, or anything else specific to that customer — Veronica's first-line response is the following, delivered verbatim:

"We have customer reference rights with each Founding Member that we honor on the timeline each customer prefers. I can speak to the protocol itself and to our public commitments. What would you like to know about the Foundation governance structure or the cryptographic guarantees of the protocol?"

The response accomplishes three things: it acknowledges the question without engaging it, it asserts a defensible principle (customer-reference timing is customer-controlled), and it redirects to Foundation governance — the topic on which Veronica is most credible and on which the FAQ above provides comprehensive backup.

3.2 The four-hour rule

When a journalist's question touches on a specific customer or that customer's parent or affiliated entities, Veronica's response is always:

"Let me get back to you within the hour."

She then immediately Signal-messages the Brunswick lead with the journalist name, outlet, exact question, and deadline. Brunswick responds within 30 minutes with the recommended written response. Veronica reviews, edits if needed, and replies to the journalist within 4 hours.

The four-hour rule exists because Veronica's first instinct will be to answer substantively in the moment. That instinct is wrong in this scenario. Brunswick's role is to slow the loop just enough that the response is composed, not reactive.

3.3 Off-limits topics

Veronica does not discuss the following in any setting — on the record, on background, off the record, with friendly journalists, or in social conversation that could be later attributed:

- Any specific customer's ownership structure.
- The internal sequencing of customer commitments (who signed first, who was approached when).
- The fact that counterweight outreach was a deliberate strategy.
- The cost or scope of Brunswick's engagement.
- The existence of this document.

"Off the record" with a journalist is not a safe channel for these topics. Journalists honor off-the-record reliably for sources they need to protect; they do not always honor it for sources they are competing to break. The cost of a single slip on any of the above is catastrophic and not recoverable.

3.4 Escalation tree

```
Journalist question on a specific customer ownership concern
↓
Veronica responds within 5 minutes: "Let me get back to you within the hour."
↓
Veronica Signal-messages Brunswick lead within 10 minutes.
↓
Brunswick lead drafts response within 30 minutes; sends to Veronica.
↓
Veronica reviews, edits if needed; sends to journalist within 4 hours of original question.
↓
If journalist publishes a story Veronica considers materially inaccurate:
↓
Brunswick contacts outlet editor within 24 hours requesting correction.
↓
Veronica does NOT respond publicly until Brunswick has placed the correction request.
```

The escalation tree applies equally to social-media posts. A founder LinkedIn post or X thread that engages with a customer ownership question is functionally a press response and is governed by the same protocol.

4. Riot SOW deferral playbook

4.1 The amendment

The Jun 18 Riot Strategic Beta Partner SOW is amended on or before Jun 26 to convert public-attribution status to private design-partner status. The commercial terms — \$1.0M commitment, integration scope, support SLAs, reference rights for non-public use cases — are unchanged. Only the public-attribution clause is modified.

Specifically, Section 7.2 of the SOW (the public-attribution clause as drafted) is replaced with language reading, in substance:

The Parties agree that LedgerProof Inc. will not publicly attribute the relationship between the Parties prior to a mutually agreed re-attribution date. The Parties will jointly assess the appropriate re-attribution date no earlier than October 1, 2026 and no later than December 31, 2026, with the goal of public attribution in the Q4 2026 announcement cycle. Until re-attribution, the relationship is governed by the Confidentiality terms in Section 9.

Cooley M&A counsel drafts the redline. The redline is sent to Riot's deal counsel within 48 hours of trigger activation. The Riot champion (Frank, Director of AI Platform) is briefed by Veronica directly before the redline lands at Riot's legal team.

4.2 Briefing Frank

Frank is the Riot internal champion and the deal's continued momentum depends on him not feeling blindsided. Veronica calls Frank within 24 hours of trigger. The conversation has three beats:

First beat — what's changing: "Frank, I want to walk you through a change we're proposing to the SOW before our counsel sends the redline. The commercial terms are unchanged. The only change is the public-attribution clause — we're proposing to defer the announcement to Q4 instead of Jul 6."

Second beat — why: "We've been working on a counterweight Founding Member to land in the same launch window. That outreach has not closed in the timeline we needed. Rather than launch Jul 6 with an unbalanced press cut, we'd rather hold the Riot announcement for Q4 when we can pair it with the right context. The deal economics are the same. We honor everything we promised you operationally. The change is purely about external sequencing."

Third beat — what Frank gets: "What you get in return: continued executive sponsorship from me personally, first-customer-status in our Q4 announcement (which will be a bigger press cycle than Jul 6 anyway because it lands alongside the Founding Member cohort confirmed), and a \$50K discount on the Year 2 renewal that we'll document in the amendment. I want this to be a win for you internally, not a delay you have to explain."

The \$50K Year 2 discount is the cost of the conversation landing without friction. Cheap relative to losing the deal entirely.

4.3 Commercial preservation

The deal economics (\$1.0M Year 1 commitment) are unchanged. No cash discount on Year 1. The integration scope is unchanged. The support SLAs are unchanged. The reference rights — for non-public use — are unchanged; Riot can still use the relationship in board materials, in regulatory filings, and in internal Tencent reporting. They simply cannot use the relationship in external press until re-attribution.

The Year 2 \$50K discount is a goodwill gesture documented in the amendment as a one-time concession. It does not establish a pattern; it does not create renewal-pricing precedent for other customers because the SOW is private design-partner status, not the standard Strategic Beta Partner contract template.

4.4 Re-attribution timeline

Target Q4 2026 announcement once at least one Tier-A counterweight Founding Member is in place. The Q4 announcement frames Riot and the counterweight as the first cohort of production deployments, with the Foundation governance story carried over from Jul 6. The Q4 announcement is a planned communications event with Brunswick involvement and a 60-day lead time on press coordination.

If no counterweight has confirmed by Sep 30, 2026 — the Hercules debt facility tranche-trigger date — the re-attribution decision is reassessed. The default is to continue holding; the alternative is to consider whether the launch coverage cost of holding Riot is less than the customer-retention cost of holding indefinitely. Veronica makes that call with Brunswick input.

5. Launch press kit recut

5.1 What comes out

- The Riot logo on the launch press release.
- Any quote attributed to a Riot executive.
- The Tier-A Founding Member section of the launch deck currently designed to include the counterweight commitment.
- The FT op-ed co-byline draft (which had been positioned for joint Veronica + counterweight CEO authorship).

5.2 What stays in

- The Foundation incorporation announcements (US 501(c)(3) Delaware filing date and Form 1023 status; Dutch Stichting EU subsidiary KvK Amsterdam registration date; Board composition).
- The protocol specification public release (open-source repository link, IETF SCITT WG draft submission).
- The audit memo posture: NCC Group engagement letter signed, Trail of Bits and Cure53 engagement letters in progress, target memo publication Aug 31. The fact that the audit is in progress and not yet complete is stated plainly; we do not imply completion.
- The DIN application filing and CEN-CENELEC JTC 21 participation.

- The Founding Member pipeline list with the Founding Members who have confirmed publishable on Jul 6, however small that list is. If the list is empty, we lead with the Foundation and the protocol; we do not invent customers.

5.3 What gets added

- A short section on the Foundation's governance independence framework, with a link to the Foundation Independence FAQ (§2 above).
- A statement on Foundation diversity of funding sources and capped-contribution policy.
- The Foundation Board member biographies, emphasizing independent technical and governance credentials.
- The Mistral coupling announcement if it landed (supply-side commitment to emit LPR receipts — different from a buyer-side Founding Member but useful as evidence of protocol adoption breadth).

5.4 Press kit lock date

The original press kit lock date was Jun 30. The recut date is **Jul 1, EOD PDT**. The one-day slip absorbs the recut workflow. The Jul 1 date is non-negotiable; further slip cascades into the Jul 3 FT op-ed deadline and the Jul 5 embargo distribution.

5.5 FT op-ed pivot

The FT op-ed planned for Jul 3 publication shifts from a co-bylined commercial-momentum piece to a Veronica solo byline focused on Foundation governance. Working title: *"Why AI compliance needs public-interest infrastructure — and what makes a foundation actually independent."*

The op-ed argues that the EU AI Act creates a structural problem (compliance evidence is needed by every deployer, but no deployer wants compliance infrastructure controlled by their commercial competitor) and that the only answer is foundation-owned, openly verifiable infrastructure. The piece does not mention any specific customer. It references the protocol, the Foundation governance design, and the upcoming Aug 2 enforcement date.

Brunswick redrafts the op-ed within 72 hours of trigger activation. Veronica reviews. FT desk has been told the op-ed is coming; the substance shift does not require a new pitch, only a new draft.

6. Q4 counterweight pursuit workstream

The counterweight outreach does not stop on Jul 6. It continues post-launch as a background workstream, re-categorized in the board materials from "launch-critical" to "Q4 priority."

6.1 Targets and timing

The original five Tier-A targets remain the priority list. Allianz and ING were always Q3-Q4 timelines under best-case assumptions; FAIL-branch activation simply confirms what the timelines already implied. Klarna, Adyen, and Wise remain Jul-Aug feasible.

The Tier-B targets — Stripe, BBVA, SAP, DZ Bank, Plaid — become active in the Aug-Sep window. Brunswick coordinates the press cadence for each as they land.

6.2 The Q4 announcement

Target: at least one Tier-A counterweight Founding Member by Sep 30, 2026 — the Hercules tranche-trigger date. The Q4 announcement combines (a) the counterweight Founding Member confirmation, (b) the Riot re-attribution, and (c) any additional Founding Members confirmed between Jul and Sep. The announcement frames the cohort as the first-year customer roster.

The Q4 announcement is the second public press cycle. It is designed to be larger in coverage volume than the Jul 6 launch — Brunswick lines up a Bloomberg lead, a Politico EU AI desk feature, and a TechCrunch Disrupt-week briefing.

6.3 The Series A teaser

The Series A teaser deck (target Nov 29 distribution to selected institutional investors, per the master plan) includes the counterweight Founding Member and Riot together as the Year 1 customer roster. Qatalyst Partners coordinates the institutional distribution. The teaser does not lead with customer logos — it leads with Aug 2 enforcement adoption metrics, protocol receipt volume, and Foundation governance independence as the durable moat.

7. Cost of activation

7.1 External costs

Line item	Hours / fee	Cost
Brunswick crisis-prep, Jun 23 - Jul 6	~40 hours @ €1500/day fractional rate	~€7,500
Brunswick press-kit recut + FT op-ed redraft	~20 hours additional	~€3,750
Cooley M&A counsel — Riot SOW amendment redline	~10 hours @ ~\$1,000/hr	~\$10,000
Brunswick Q4 re-announcement coordination	~30 hours over Sep-Oct	~€5,000
Subtotal external		~€16,250 + ~\$10,000

7.2 Founder time

Line item	Hours
Veronica direct on Brunswick brief and Riot champion call	~10 hours week of Jun 22
Veronica direct on FT op-ed redraft	~12 hours week of Jun 24
Veronica direct on press-kit recut review	~8 hours week of Jun 24
Veronica direct on Q4 announcement preparation	~20 hours over Aug-Oct
Veronica direct on Jul 6 launch coverage (recut version)	~30 hours week of Jul 6
Subtotal founder time	~80 hours

7.3 Total cost

Approximately **€20-25K in external fees** plus **~80 hours of founder time** spread over Jun 22 - Oct 31. Roughly half of the founder time is time that would have been spent on launch coverage anyway; the incremental founder-time cost of activating the package is closer to 40 hours.

7.4 The asymmetric comparison

Cost of NOT having this package ready and absorbing the press cycle without preparation:

- Estimated 80-90% of Jul 6 launch press value redirected toward the customer-ownership story instead of the protocol and Foundation story.
- Brussels regulatory positioning friction: meetings with DG-CNECT, the EU AI Office, and ENISA become harder to schedule for the subsequent 60 days.

- Customer-acquisition cost increase: Founding Member pipeline conversion rate drops as press cycle interferes with the closing conversations.
- Estimated equivalent value loss: **€1-3M in customer-acquisition cost equivalent** plus an unquantifiable but real drag on Series A valuation conversations in Q1 2027.

The cost-benefit ratio of preparation is approximately **100:1 in favor of having the package ready**. The package exists not because we expect to need it — we don't — but because the consequence of needing it and not having it is catastrophic.

8. Stand-down conditions

The package activation is reversible until specific irreversible commitments are executed. Stand-down conditions are:

8.1 Best-case stand-down: Tier-A confirms Jun 22 18:01 PDT to Jun 30 EOD PDT

If a Tier-A counterweight signs publishable LOI in this window, the original Jul 6 plan resumes with a one-week reschedule of the FT op-ed (to Jul 10 instead of Jul 3) to absorb the recut-to-original swap. The launch date itself remains Jul 6. Riot SOW amendment is aborted if Cooley has not yet sent the redline; if the redline has been sent but not executed, it is withdrawn with a brief explanation to Riot deal counsel ("our timing constraints have changed; we're returning to the original SOW as drafted"). Frank gets a follow-up call to the same effect.

The cost of best-case stand-down: ~€8,000 in Brunswick hours already burned, ~€2,000 in Cooley hours, plus reputational marginal cost with Riot deal counsel (small but nonzero — they noticed we wobbled).

8.2 Tight-case stand-down: Tier-A confirms Jul 1 to Jul 5

If a Tier-A counterweight signs publishable LOI in this window, the original Jul 6 plan resumes with a last-minute press-kit re-edit and a same-day FT op-ed substantive revision. The risk profile is high — there is real possibility of an inconsistency between embargoed materials distributed Jul 5 and final launch materials Jul 6 — but the execution is doable if the counterweight executive is committed to working with us through the recut weekend. Brunswick coordinates the press-kit final edit; Veronica is on call continuously Jul 5 EOD to Jul 6 02:00 GMT.

The cost of tight-case stand-down: ~€12,000 in Brunswick hours, ~€10,000 in Cooley hours (Riot SOW amendment is likely already executed by Jul 1; the SOW amendment cannot be reversed in 5 days). The Riot re-attribution timeline becomes Q4 either way once the SOW amendment is executed.

8.3 No stand-down: Tier-A confirms Jul 6 or later

If no Tier-A confirms by Jul 5 but one confirms after Jul 6, the package is fully executed and the late-arriving counterweight becomes the Q4 announcement headline alongside Riot re-attribution. Total cost: full €20-25K + 80 founder hours.

8.4 The one-way door

Once the Riot SOW amendment is executed (target Jun 26), the public-attribution-deferral commitment is irreversible for the Jul 6 launch cycle. A subsequent amendment to re-add Riot to Jul 6 attribution is not feasible on the timeline. The amendment is the package's one-way door. Veronica considers carefully on Jun 25 EOD whether to instruct Cooley to send the redline on Jun 26 or to hold for 24 more hours. The default is to send on Jun 26 to preserve the Jul 1 press-kit lock date; the default is overridden only if a Tier-A counterweight indicates a high-probability sign within 48 hours.

9. Operational artifacts

This package depends on the following artifacts being drafted and ready for execution on Jun 22 trigger:

- [x] This document, complete and signed off by Veronica
- [] Foundation Independence FAQ as a standalone PDF, ready for Foundation website publication
- [] Cooley draft of Riot SOW Section 7.2 replacement language, reviewed but not sent
- [] Brunswick engagement letter for crisis-prep retainer, signed and on file (Jun 10 deadline per master plan)
- [] FT desk pre-positioned that an op-ed substance shift may occur within 7 days of Jul 3 publication
- [] Press-kit recut template prepared by Maria Chen, with Foundation governance section pre-drafted
- [] Veronica's Riot champion-call script reviewed and rehearsed
- [] Encrypted Signal channel established between Veronica and Brunswick lead with shared codeword convention

Outstanding artifacts above are tracked in `ops-state.json` under KS3 sub-tasks with owners and target completion dates.

10. Decision log

Activation, stand-down, or modification of this package is logged here with timestamp, decision-maker, and brief reasoning. The log is the single authoritative record of how the package was operated.

Timestamp	Decision	By	Reasoning
2026-06-01 20:35 PDT	Package drafted and committed to repository	Veronica	Standing artifact, no activation yet

File location

`/Users/veronicadawkins/Documents/LedgerProof-Launch-July6/14-seed-close-pack/ks3-fail-branch-brunswick-prep.md`

Linked from: `04-atomic-explosion-master-plan.md` §8 (KS3); `counterweight-anchor-targets.md` Path 2; `ops-state.json` KS3.

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